On November 1, I saw Campbell, gave him "Youth," then drove back to Waltham. To my delight, David seemed to have thriven in my absence, and Gertrude had been able to take care of him without too much trouble.

That night, however, I felt the now-familiar pains of a kidney stone. My regimen of drinking water paid off, however. The pains were not nearly so bad as they had been a year before. I increased my water intake further, and after six days of intermittent discomfort, passed the stone. It was a tiny thing compared to the earlier one.

10

Fred Pohl visited us on November 10. It was a surprise visit; I hadn't expected him. It gave him a chance to admire David, however.

He brought some bad news: Campbell had rejected "Youth." (Later on, Gold was to reject it, too.) Fred spent some time telling me that I ought to write nonfiction articles. That, he said, was where the money was. He impressed me and I did not forget, but at the time, I was not ready.

11

On November 15, we drove to New York with David. He was nearly three months old now and it was on this occasion that my mother and father saw their first grandchild for the first time.

Among those whom I saw on my rounds on this occasion was Howard Browne, who was once again trying to start a high-class science-fiction magazine and who wanted stories badly.

When I got back to Boston, I started a story named "Button, Button" intended for Browne. Once again, I was attempting a humorous story, and once again, as in the case of "The Monkey's Finger," I overdid it badly. Those days, though, I could finish a story in four days, so the time investment wasn't overpowering.

On November 25, we moved David's crib out of the bedroom and set it up in the fourth room that I had been using as my workroom. After fourteen weeks, he had a room of his own—and I didn't. For half

a year I had had a room to work in all to myself but now I had to move my typewriter, desk, and chair into the bedroom.